YUDI ZENG

INTERDISCIPLINARY DESIGNER · INDEPENDENT OPERATOR · PRACTICE-BASED RESEARCHER

Xiamen, China | yzeng19970104@gmail.com

POSITION

Design-trained practitioner working across human experience, cultural systems, institutions, and emerging technologies.

EDUCATION

Xiamen University *· Non-degree Anthropology & Ethnology · Fall 2025*

Kent State University *B.A. Fashion Design · Minor in Studio Art 2017–2021 · Kent, Ohio, USA*

Xiamen Academy of Arts and Design, Fuzhou University *Fashion design· 2018 SUMMER*

Dankook University *Study aboard· 2019 SUMMER*

University of Maine *Undergraduate study · Major Business to Studio Art 2014–2016 · Orono, Maine, USA*

METHODS & PRACTICE

RESEARCH Qualitative inquiry · Case documentation · Study-structure development

SYSTEMS Stakeholder coordination · Institutional navigation · Spatial implementation

HUMAN–AI Structured prompt design · AI-mediated interpretation · Interaction prototyping

DESIGN Fashion / costume · Visual systems · Spatial design · Material practice · Sustainable / circular design

LANGUAGES

- Mandarin (native)
- English (professional)
- French (self-directed study)

CROSS-CULTURAL PRACTICE

China · United States · South Korea · Italy · France · UAE

Study, work, and creative practice across different educational, cultural, and production environments.

LEADERSHIP & IMPACT

URBAN MICRO-ECOSYSTEM GOVERNANCE *independent liaison · Xiamen · Jan 2022-Nov 2023*

2022–23: Coordinated a multi-party response to a threatened demolition of two garages, navigating local administrative procedures, resident coordination, and technical/property evidence through Jimei District proceedings. Nov. 2023: the district authority rescinded the administrative decision; the court subsequently approved withdrawal of the related suit.

SUS CLINIC — CIRCULAR DESIGN VENTURE *Principal, designer & operator · Xiamen· May 2023–Present*

Founded and operate a circular venture connecting vintage garments, surplus materials, remake, consignment, sourcing, markets, and customer relationships. Built a working micro-ecosystem from spatial and operational constraints.

RESEARCH & COLLABORATION

BEFORE YOU KNOW — Study 0 *AI-mediated interpretation · 2026–Present*

Exploratory within-participant pilot examining how AI intervention before interpretive closure may shape subsequent reflection and revision. Developed the study protocol, ambiguous visual stimuli, AI-mediated dialogue, participant sessions, and initial qualitative analysis. Pilot study underway; data collection and initial analysis in progress.

FEMALE ARTISTIC NARRATIVE RESEARCH *Field research contributor · Prof. Xinyan Lu ·2022*

Contributed to the National Social Science Arts project “Research on Female Narratives in Traditional Chinese Paper-cutting,” with field research and contextual documentation across Northeast China, Inner Mongolia, and Chaoshan. Discuss together the narrative elements and metaphors in shamanic culture and female art, as well as the possibilities of integrating them into contemporary development.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

XIPING BILINGUAL SCHOOL *Design & visual teacher · Jan–Aug 2025· Xiamen.*

Designed and taught bilingual, project-based design learning; guided students through observation, critique, making, research activities, exhibitions, and market events.

YONG EXPERIMENTAL THEATRE *Costume & visual designer · Jan–Jun 2024 · xiamen/wuzhen*

Translated scripts and characters into costumes/visual systems while integrating materials, prototyping, movement, safety, and stage presentation.

YOUYA FACTORY × SHEIN *Design / supply-chain project · Aug–Dec 2023 · Quanzhou*

Served as a design-to-production bridge across design, pattern, purchasing, production, quality, technical documentation, sampling, cost, schedule, and final inspection.

ORGANIC EMOTION Ou Yisi Yu Trading Co., Ltd *Design Director · Nov 2021–Oct 2022 · Xiamen.*

Led seasonal product development from market/trend research through concept, sampling, production coordination, and commercial delivery; balanced design intent with cost, quality, and manufacturability.

LILANZ (CHINA) CO., LTD *Fashion Designer · May–Nov 2021 · Quanzhou*

Key designer for LESS IS MORE × TIEN & FANG S/S22; independently developed four complete looks presented at Shanghai Fashion Week S/S22.

EMBODIED PRACTICE.

Dance & performance training / instruction · 2000–Present
Piano professional training · 2003–Present

SELECTED CREATIVE CONTEXT

Richard Taittinger Gallery (selected exhibition) · Shanghai Fashion Week S/S22 · Yong Experimental Theatre Costume Design(Jan–Jun 2024)